

An Act

ENROLLED HOUSE
BILL NO. 2893

By: Townley, Rosecrants, and
Waldron of the House

and

Pederson of the Senate

An Act relating to education; amending 70 O.S. 2021, Section 6-127A, which relates to public school paraprofessionals; exempting certain paraprofessionals from certain educational requirements; exempting certain teachers from certain additional educational requirements; providing for codification; providing an effective date; and declaring an emergency.

SUBJECT: Education

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 6-127A, is amended to read as follows:

Section 6-127A. A. The Oklahoma Legislature recognizes that public school paraprofessionals play an important role in educating school children and in assisting teachers. The Legislature further recognizes the increasing role of public school paraprofessionals in the school system in light of teacher shortages. To achieve the goal of excellence for all persons who have an impact on student learning, it is the intent of the Oklahoma Legislature that public school paraprofessionals be afforded career opportunities and economic incentives through a career development program.

B. The State Board of Education shall adopt a program for the career development of public school paraprofessionals. The purpose of the program is to provide to public school paraprofessionals a system of career development which is based upon education and training advancement to encourage excellence among public school paraprofessionals. Public school paraprofessionals who hold a bachelor's degree in education or education studies and who have not

been out of the classroom for more than ten (10) years shall be deemed to have satisfied any rule that requires additional professional education coursework from an institution of higher education under the adopted program. Nothing in this section shall be construed to require public school paraprofessionals to participate in the career development program.

C. The board of education of a school district shall have authority to extend an existing contract with a public school paraprofessional that provides for the payment of compensation for paraprofessional services rendered for the same time period during which the paraprofessional is also assigned to the school district for practice teaching as a student teacher.

D. For the purposes of this section, a public school paraprofessional is an employee of a school district whose position is either instructional in nature, or who delivers other direct services to students and/or their parents. A public school paraprofessional serves in a position for which a teacher or another professional has the ultimate responsibility for the design, implementation, and evaluation of the individual educational programs or related services and student performance.

SECTION 2. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 6-213 of Title 70, unless there is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

Teachers who hold a bachelor's degree in education or education studies shall be deemed to have satisfied any State Board of Education rule that requires teachers to complete additional professional education coursework from an institution of higher education as a condition to obtain, renew, or satisfy any other professional development requirement for an emergency certificate, alternate placement teaching certificate, or standard certificate if the teacher has not been out of the classroom for more than ten (10) years.

SECTION 3. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

SECTION 4. It being immediately necessary for the preservation of the public peace, health or safety, an emergency is hereby declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

Passed the House of Representatives the 11th day of March, 2025.

Presiding Officer of the House
of Representatives

Passed the Senate the 15th day of April, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the Senate

OFFICE OF THE GOVERNOR

Received by the Office of the Governor this _____

day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

By: _____

Approved by the Governor of the State of Oklahoma this _____

day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

Governor of the State of Oklahoma

OFFICE OF THE SECRETARY OF STATE

Received by the Office of the Secretary of State this _____

day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

By: _____